

STUDENT COMPETITION



SITE LOCATION:



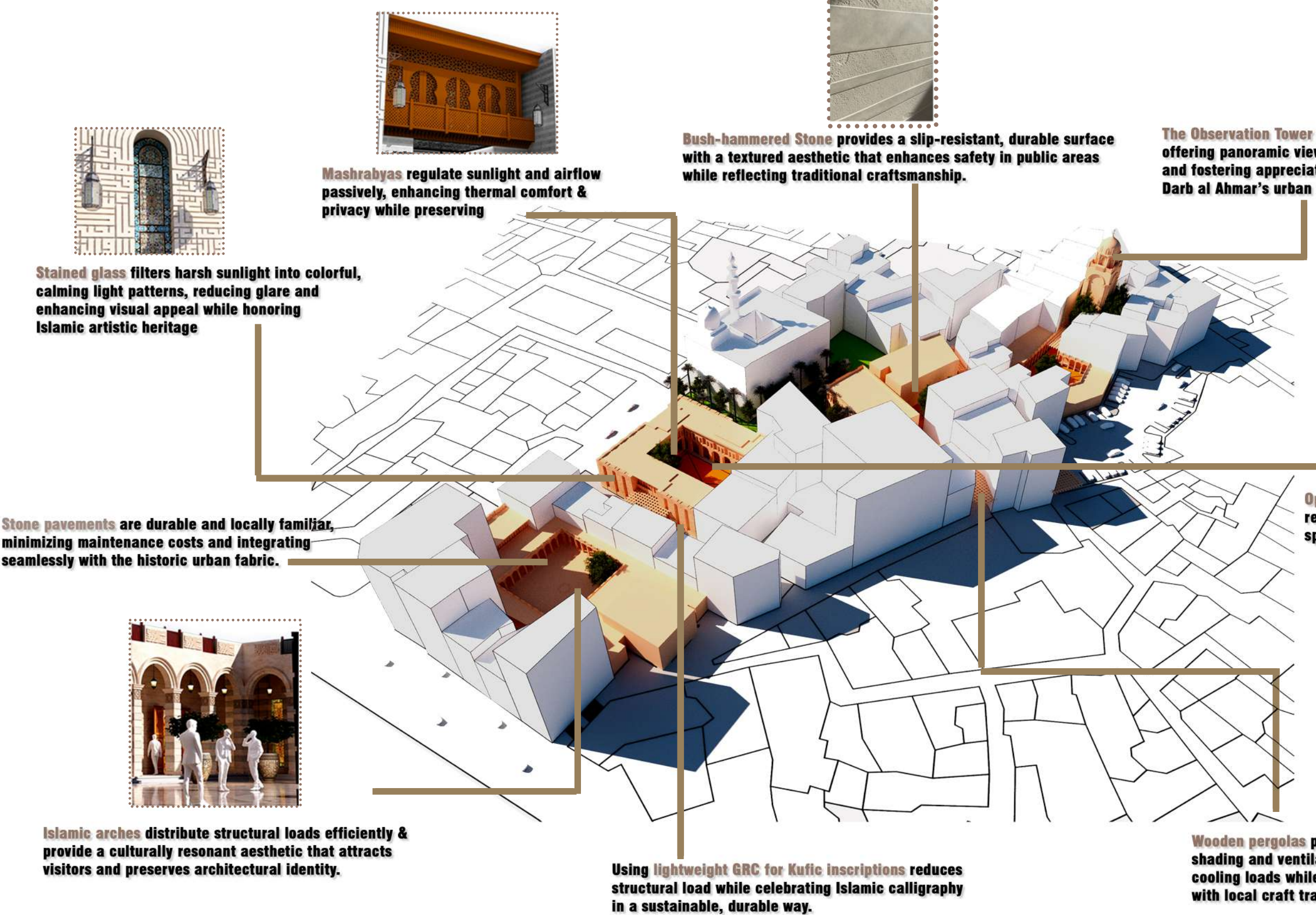
DESIGN PHILOSOPHY: PALIMPSEST

Back at the time, the word Palimpsest was used to describe a parchment paper that was used for manuscripts between people from which writing has been partially or completely erased to make room for another text. So in short, it means **reusing or altering something whilst keeping its original traces seen through its layers.**

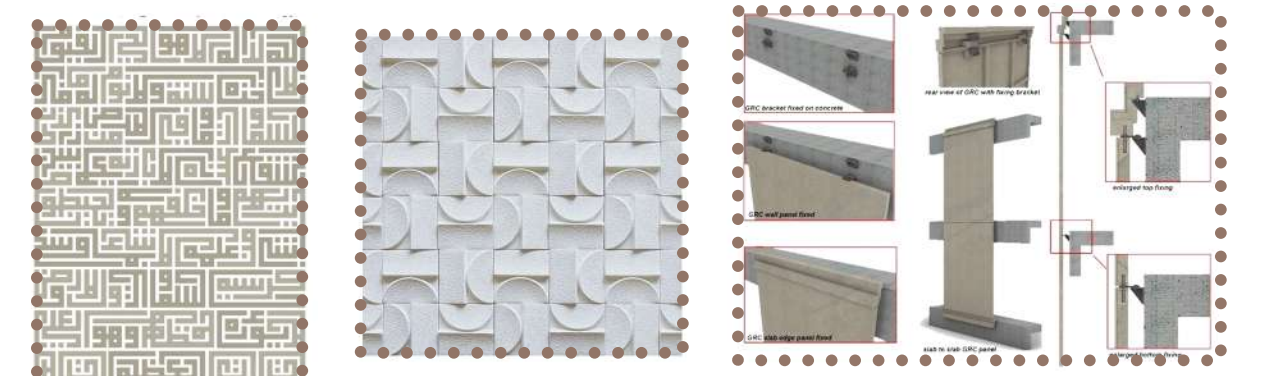


The aim of this project is to design a Contemporary Art Centre that creates a functional change to the historical context and rebirthing the place again through culture. The chosen art that my centre represents is **Arabic calligraphy** is more than ornamentation — it is a living artform, an echo of centuries past that continues to evolve. Rooted in the sacred and the poetic, this script carries not only words but the identity, rhythm, and memory of a civilization. In my design for the *Contemporary Art Center*, Arabic calligraphy becomes both metaphor and method: a palimpsest of heritage and contemporary expression.

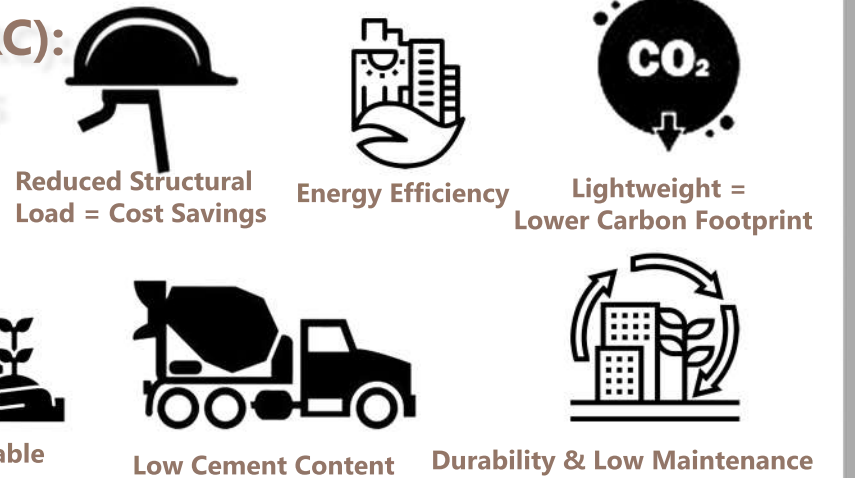
THE BUILDING FORM STUDY



MATERIALS USED:



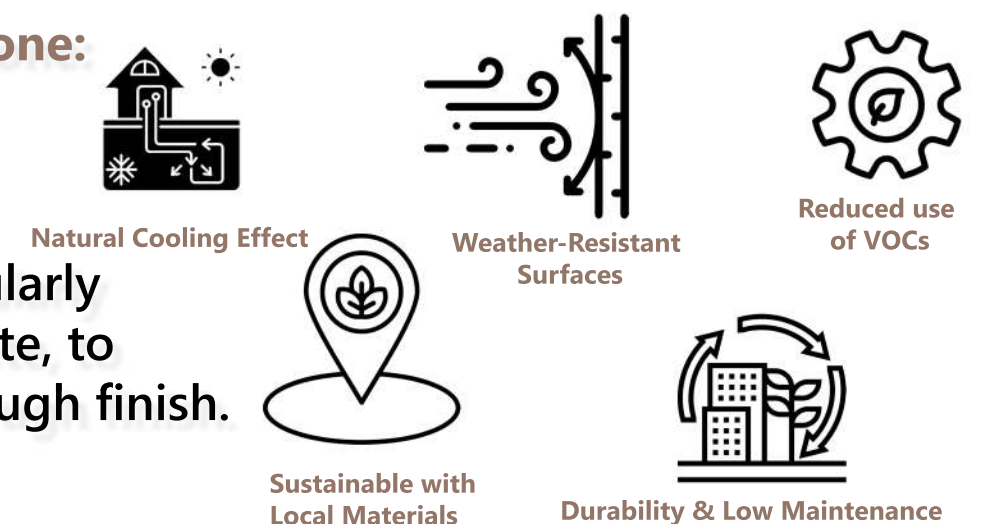
Glass Reinforced Concrete (GRC): widely used in building facades due to its versatility, strength, and sustainability



Open Islamic courts promote natural ventilation and lighting, reducing energy consumption and creating shaded communal spaces rooted in local traditions



Bush Hammered Stone: a surface treatment technique used in architecture and construction, particularly on stone and concrete, to create a textured, rough finish.

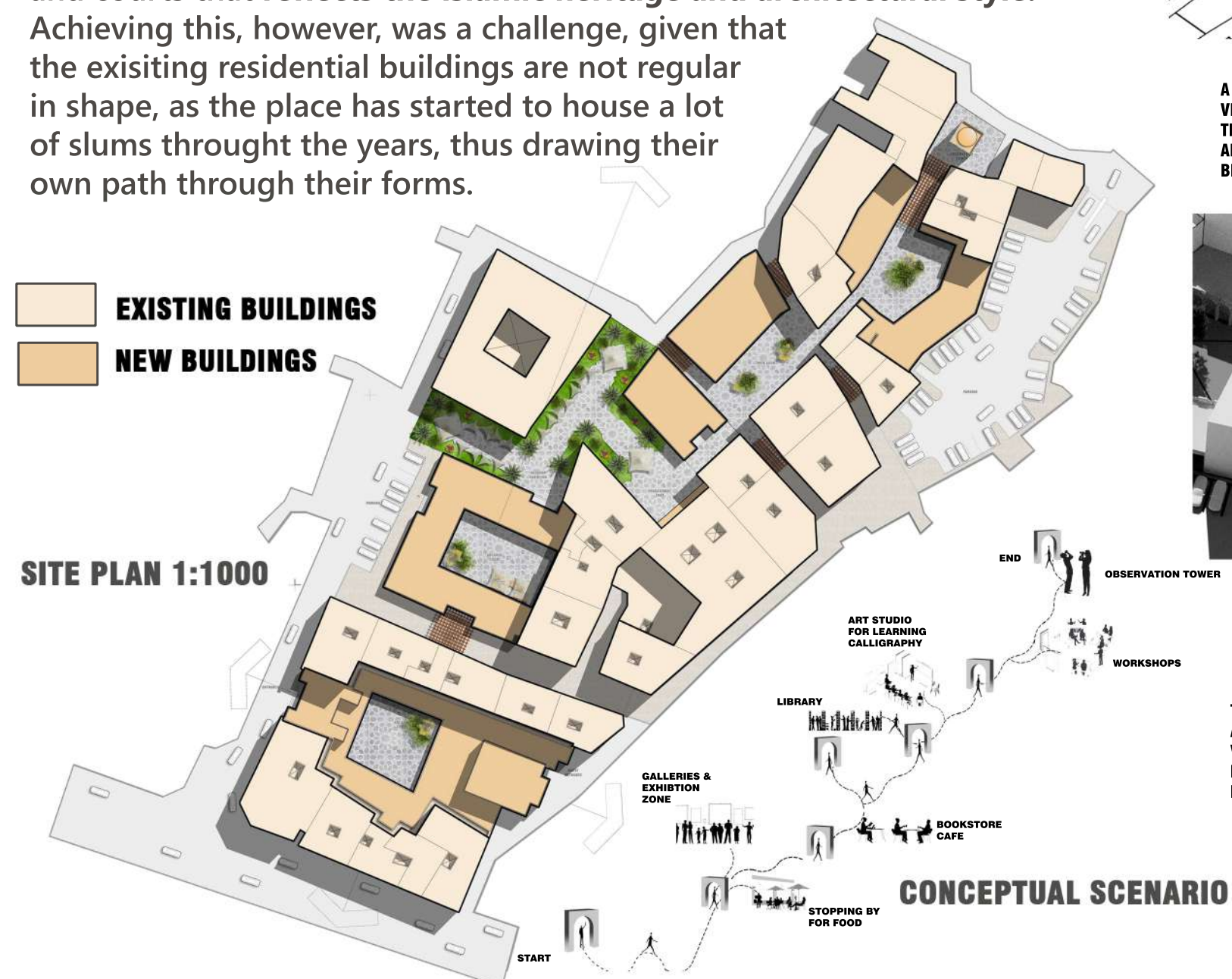


DESIGN DECISIONS

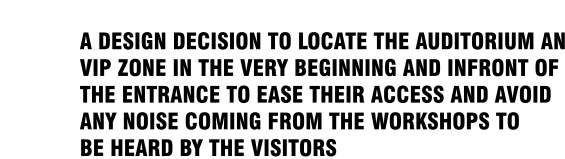
When designing in this urban context in **Souq El Silah**, it was important to keep in mind that creating a clear main spine and path that not only accentuates the **Al Jay Yousfi Mosque**, a very important historical element, but also design a path that represents the traditional arabic pathways and courts that reflects the islamic heritage and architectural style. Achieving this, however, was a challenge, given that the existing residential buildings are not regular in shape, as the place has started to house a lot of slums through the years, thus drawing their own path through their forms.

EXISTING BUILDINGS
NEW BUILDINGS

SITE PLAN 1:1000



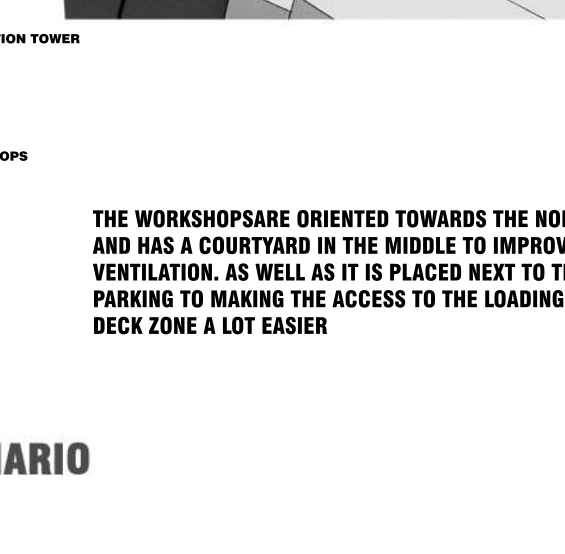
PLACING THE GALLERIES IN THE HEART OF THE SITE, NEAR THE AL JAY MOSQUE WHERE IT CONNECTS ALL PARTS OF THE PROJECT TOGETHER AND DRAWS THE ATTENTION TO THE MOST SIGNIFICANT HISTORICAL LANDMARK IN THE SITE



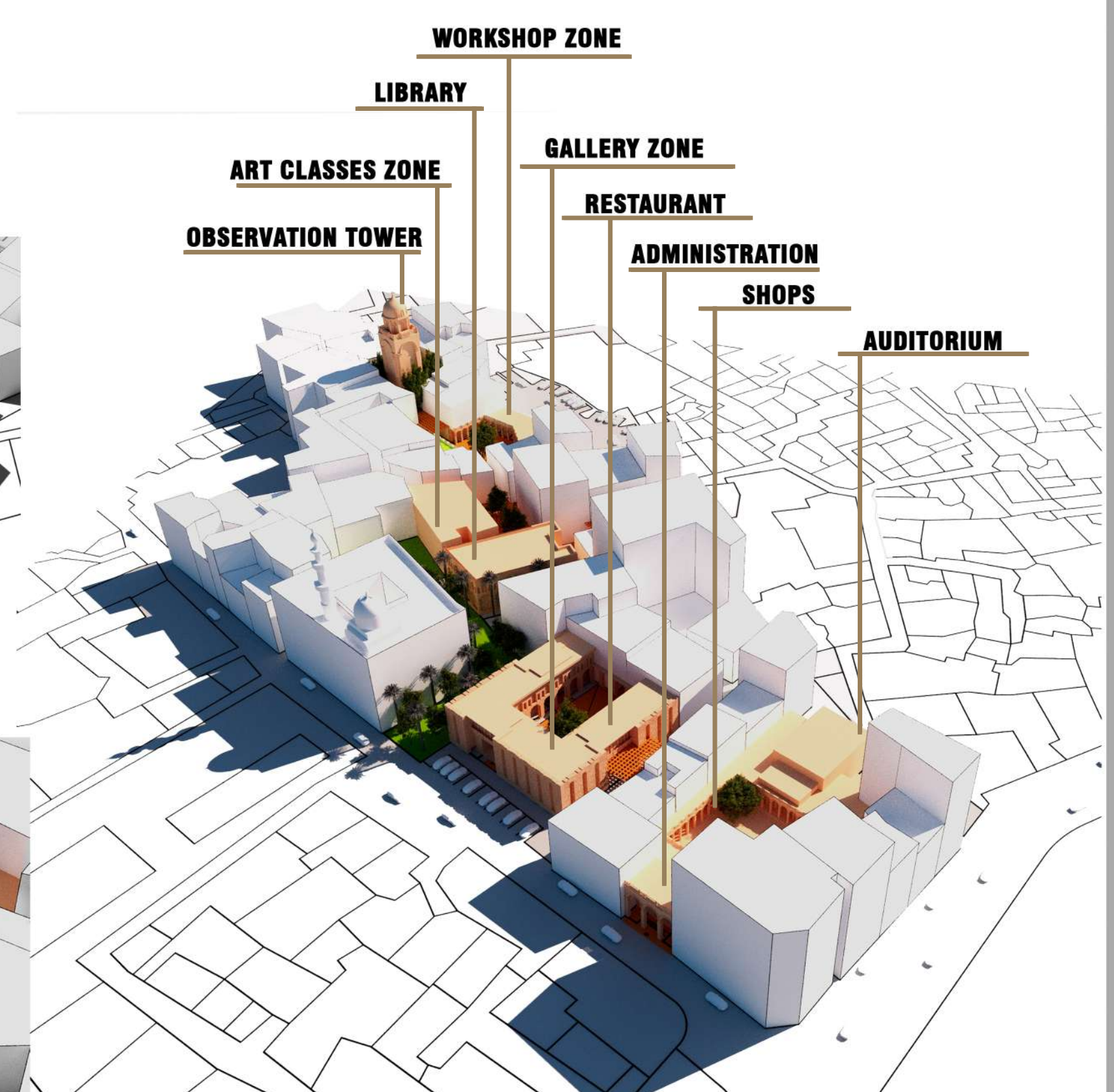
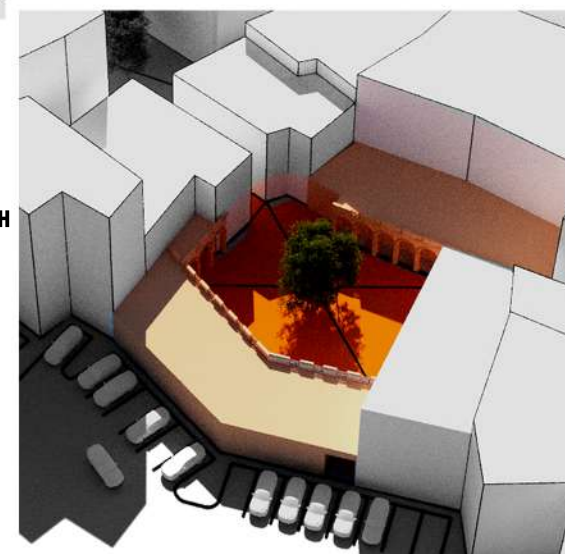
A DESIGN DECISION TO LOCATE THE AUDITORIUM AND VIP ZONE IN THE VERY BEGINNING AND FRONT OF THE ENTRANCE TO EASE THEIR ACCESS AND AVOID ANY NOISE COMING FROM THE WORKSHOPS TO BE HEARD BY THE VISITORS



THE DESIGN OF THE OBSERVATION TOWER THAT FOLLOWS THE COMPOSITE CONTEMPORARY ISLAMIC STYLE IN ORDER TO MAKE IT FEEL FAMILIAR TO BOTH THOSE WHO ARE VISITING AND THE RESIDENTS OF SOUQ EL SILAH SINCE IT IS NOT A VERY KNOWN CONCEPT TO THEM



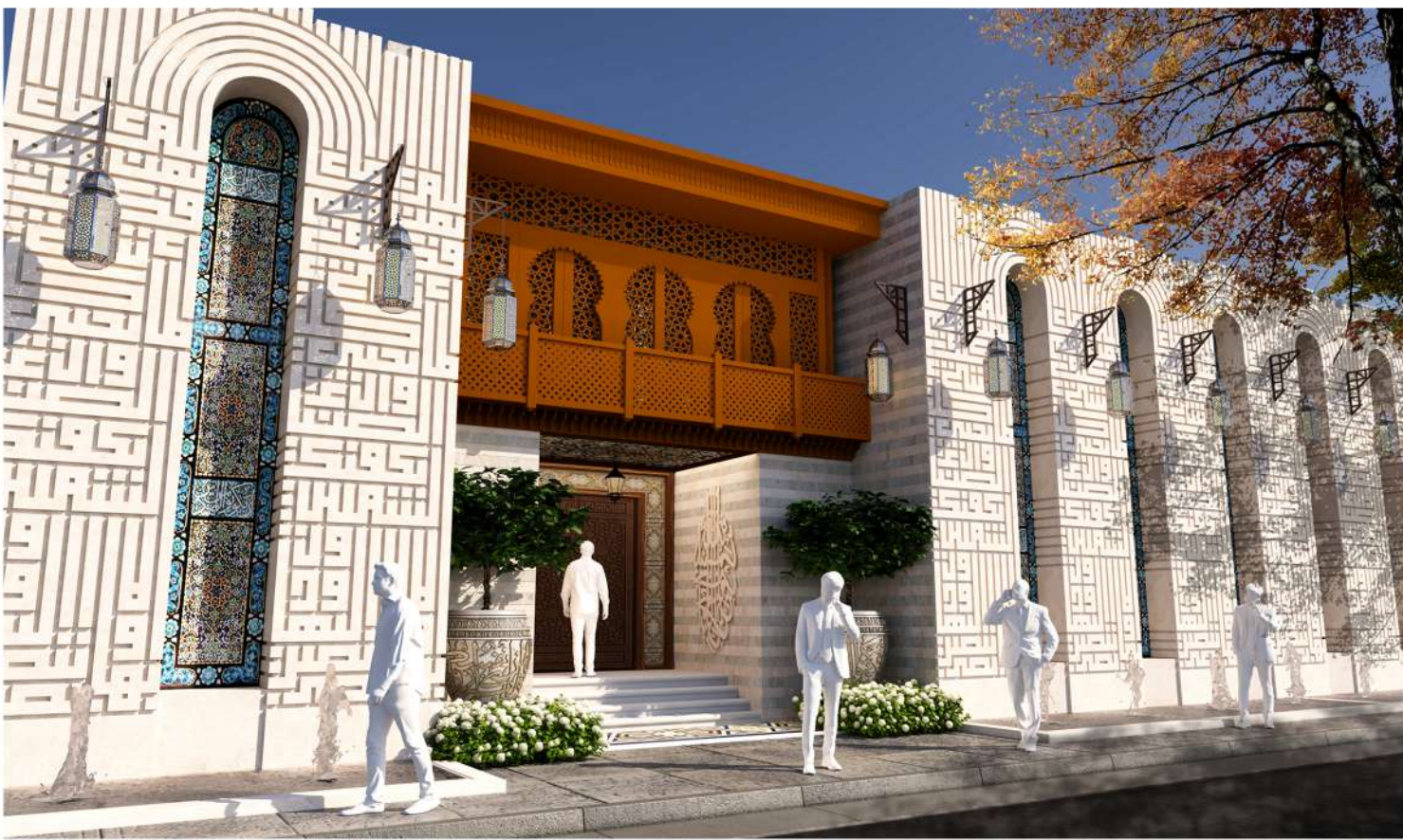
THE WORKSHOPS ARE ORIENTED TOWARDS THE NORTH AND HAS A COURTYARD IN THE MIDDLE TO IMPROVE VENTILATION. AS WELL AS IT IS PLACED NEXT TO THE PARKING TO MAKING THE ACCESS TO THE LOADING DECK ZONE A LOT EASIER



STUDENT COMPETITION

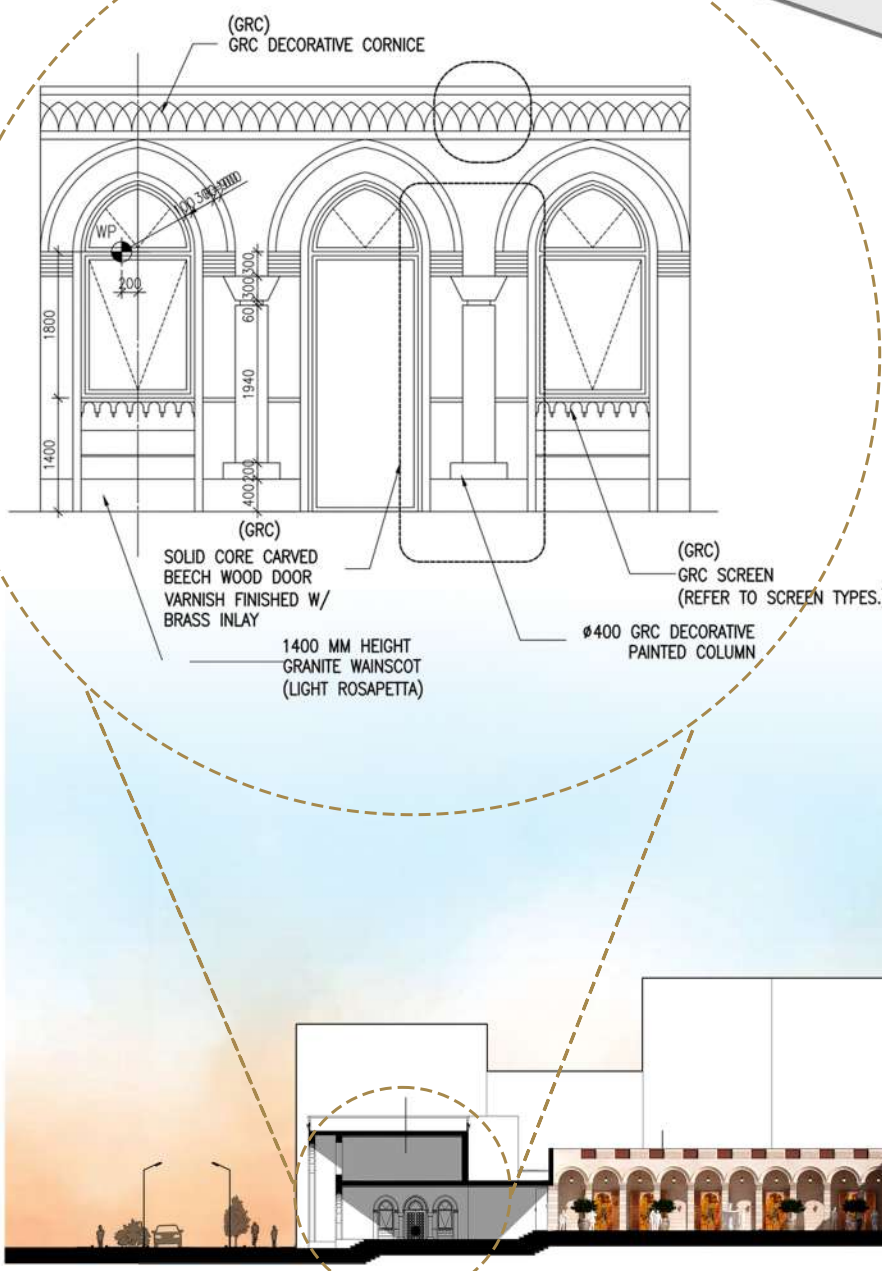
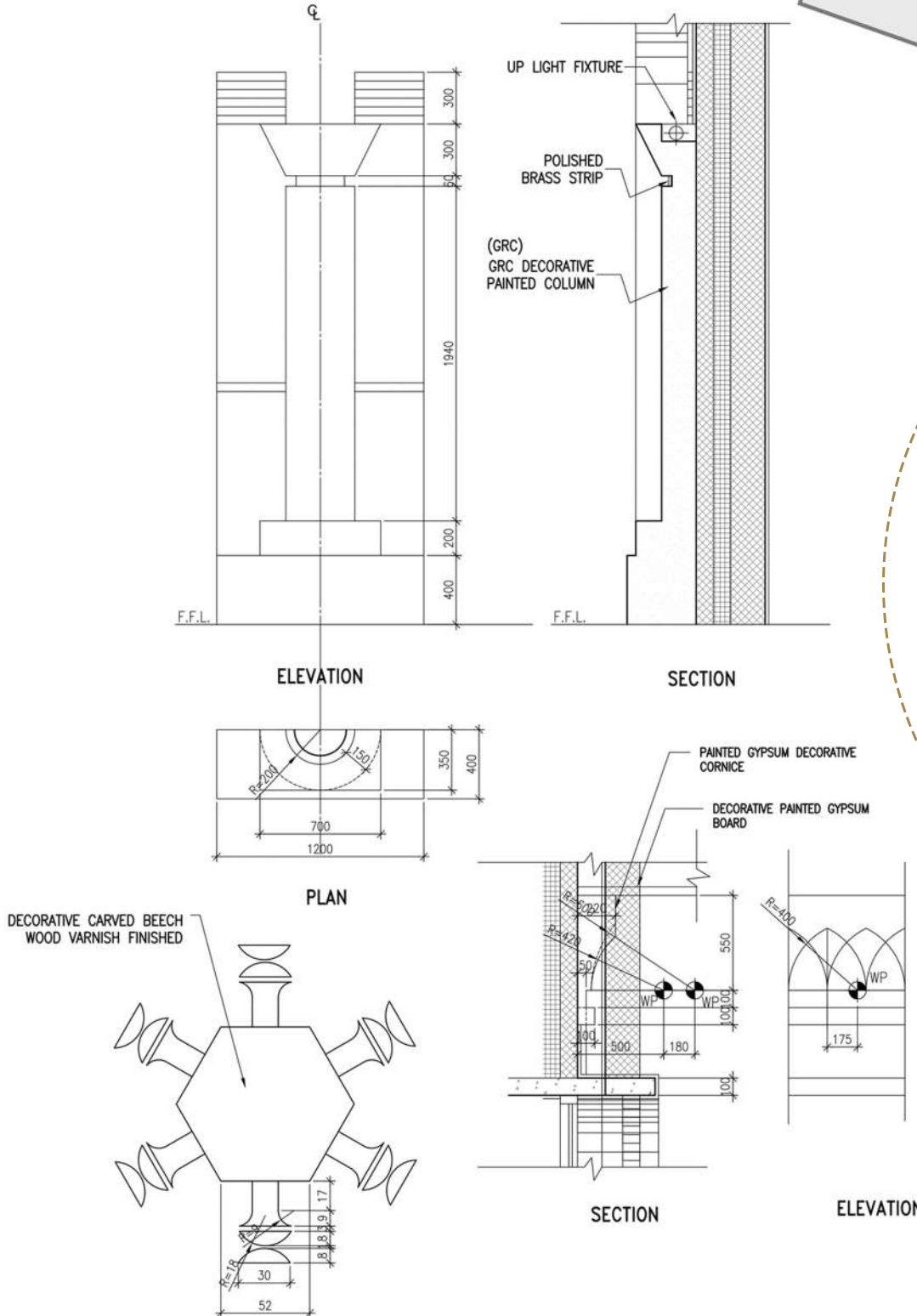


Here, the Gallery facade design combines traditional Islamic features & a contemporary modern twist, featuring a textured stone façade adorned with Kufic Calligraphy inscriptions and vibrant stained glass windows. Warm lantern-style lighting enhances the ambiance, while a grand carved wooden door and Mashrabya at the entrance, flanked by lush planters and soft floral landscaping, creates a welcoming focal point. The narrow, arched windows and decorative balcony above add verticality and cultural depth, and the use of water features along the walkway introduces tranquility and refinement to the overall composition.



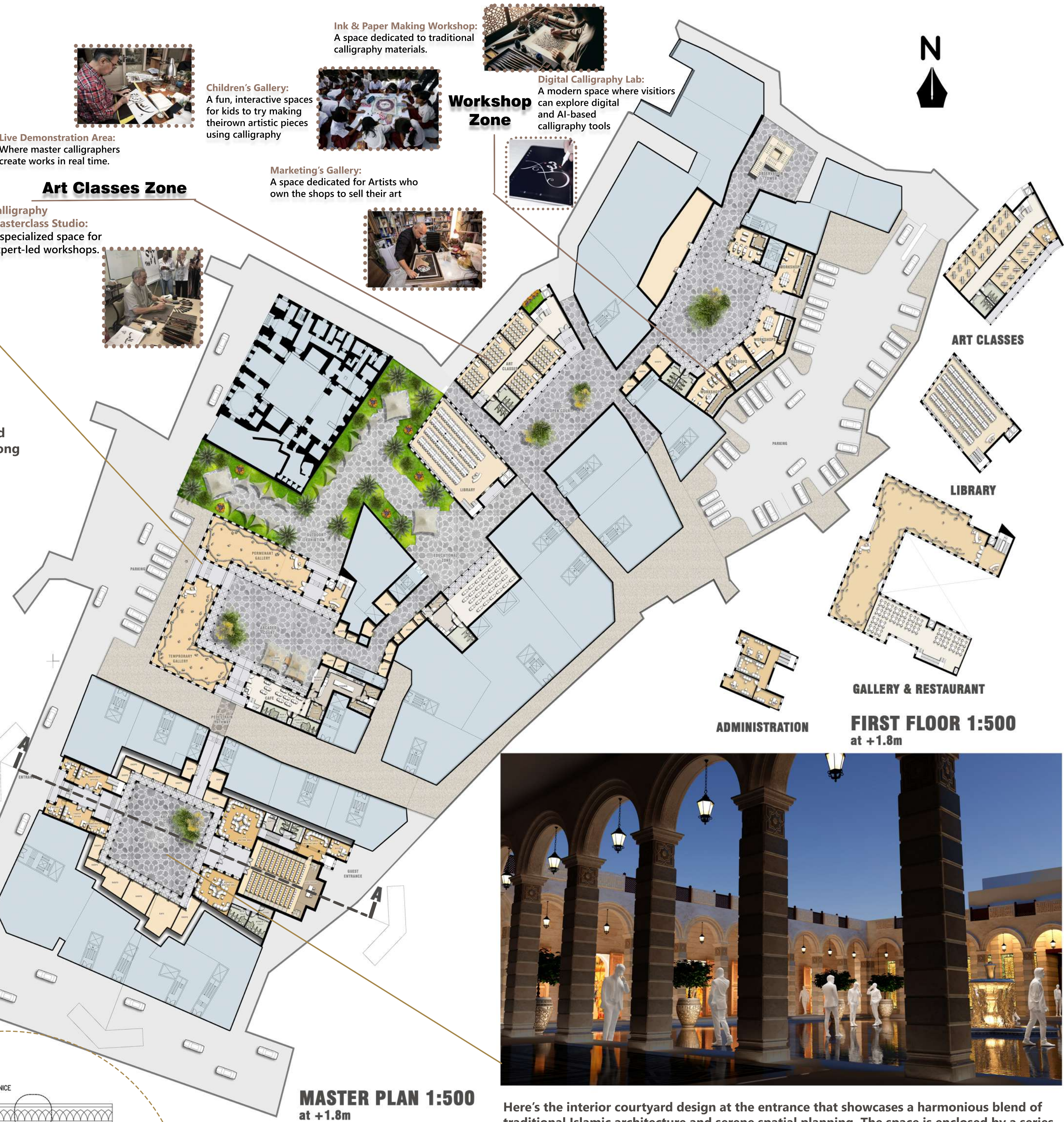
SHOT SHOWING GALLERY ENTRANCE

ARCHITECTURAL DETAILS



These are some architectural details that shows the decorations present at the door of the administration. The usage of these materials whether in the GRC or the columns, are seen throughout the entire design.

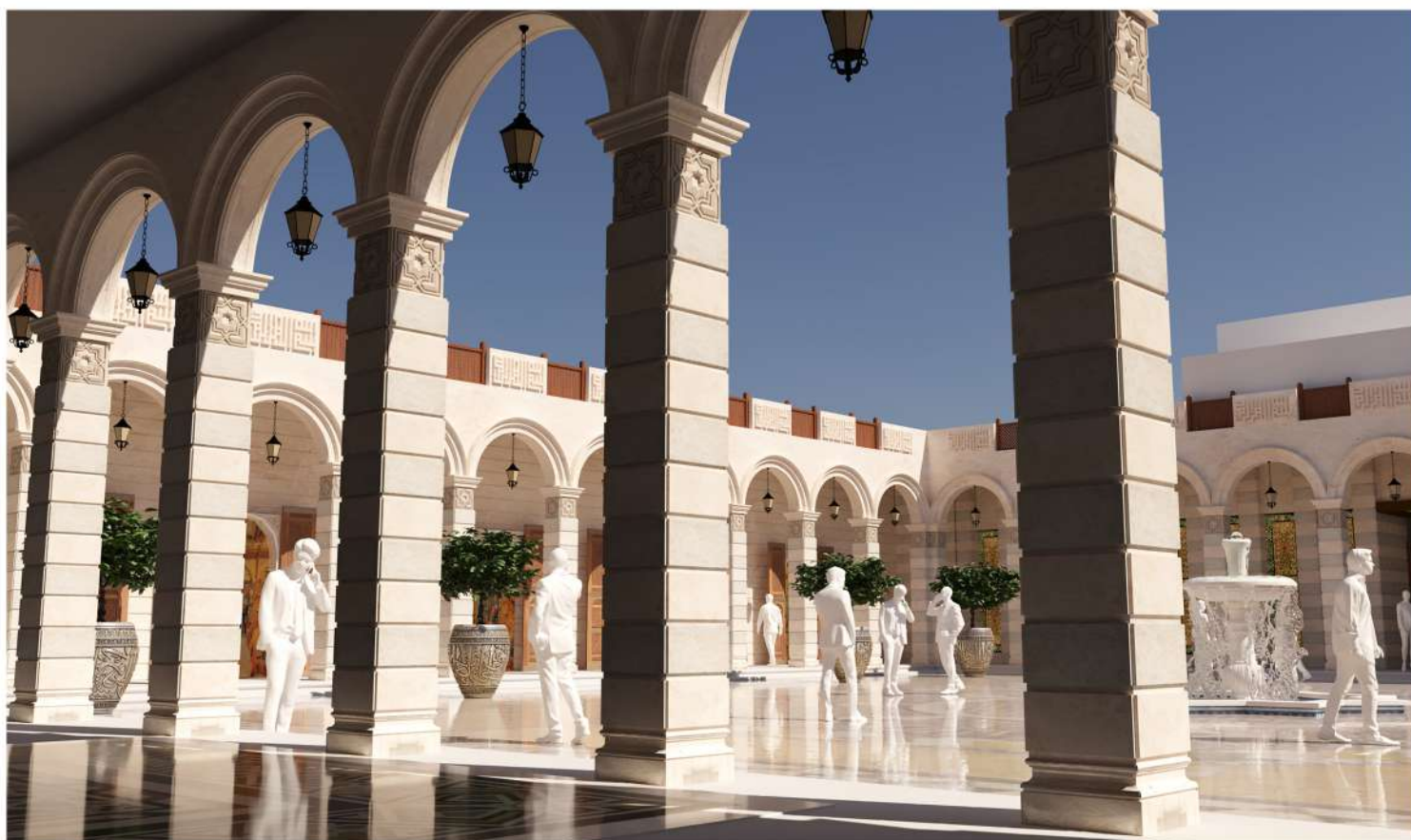
SECTION A-A 1:500



MASTER PLAN 1:500
at +1.8m



Here's the interior courtyard design at the entrance that showcases a harmonious blend of traditional Islamic architecture and serene spatial planning. The space is enclosed by a series of elegant stone arches supported by thick, striped columns featuring detailed ornamental capitals with geometric motifs. Hanging lanterns softly illuminate the area, enhancing the warm hues of the stonework. A central fountain serves as a visual and acoustic focal point, surrounded by reflective water that adds tranquility and elegance. Large ornamental planters with lush greenery bring life and balance to the symmetry of the space.



SHOT SHOWING ARACED COURT AT THE ENTRANCE



SIDE ELEVATION 1:500



MAIN ELEVATION 1:500